Norwegian Sun: Panama Canal, Hosted Solo Group

12 Nights from Miami · March 1 to 13, 2027

Ship: Norwegian Sun · **Sailing from:** Miami (PortMiami) · **Cabin:** _____ **Host:** Tina Maulsby, Maulsby Travel Co. · 910-528-5077 · tina@maulsbytravel.com

A condensed Voyage Pack from In the Wake: the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers the ship, each port, packing, budget, emergency contacts and sailing solo with the group.

Day by day

Times are from NCL's schedule for this sailing (voyage 23377868), read October 2026. **They're ship's times. Check them in the NCL app before you sail.** All aboard is one hour before departure (NCL's rule).

#	Date	Port	In port	All aboard	Worth knowing
1	Mon Mar 1	**Miami: boarding**	ship leaves 4:00 PM	3:00 PM	PortMiami lists Terminal B as NCL's; your eDocs say which. Garage B $35 a day.
2	Tue Mar 2	**Great Stirrup Cay**	7:00 AM – 4:00 PM	3:00 PM	NCL's island. Beaches and loungers free; Great Tides Waterpark extra.
3	Wed Mar 3	At sea	—	—	Book specialty dinners and excursions. Meet the group.
4	Thu Mar 4	**Cabo Rojo, DR**	9:00 AM – 3:30 PM	2:30 PM	Remote new port. NCL: no recommended shopping. Plan an excursion or a quiet day.
5	Fri Mar 5	**Aruba (Oranjestad)**	11:00 AM – 7:00 PM	6:00 PM	Main Street a 10-minute walk (Aruba tourism). Beaches are public and free.
6	Sat Mar 6	**Curaçao (Willemstad)**	7:00 AM – 5:00 PM	4:00 PM	Walkable old town; the Queen Emma Bridge swings open for ships.
7	Sun Mar 7	At sea	—	—	A slow day.
8	Mon Mar 8	**Cartagena, Colombia**	6:00 AM – 2:00 PM	**1:00 PM**	Early. The old walled city. Colombia is State Dept Level 3; Cartagena isn't in its Do Not Travel areas. Go with the group or an excursion.
9	Tue Mar 9	**Panama Canal (Gatun Lake)**	5:00 AM – 3:00 PM	—	The locks lift the ship about 85 ft (26 m) into Gatun Lake. Only booked excursion guests go ashore here.
9	Tue Mar 9	**Colón, Panama**	5:00 PM – 8:00 PM	7:00 PM	Colón 2000 Cruise Terminal. Short evening stop; stay near the terminal.
10	Wed Mar 10	**Puerto Limón, Costa Rica**	6:45 AM – 1:30 PM	**12:30 PM**	The shortest port day. NCL says guests often spot sloths in port.
11–12	Thu–Fri Mar 11–12	At sea	—	—	Rest, then pack.
13	Sat Mar 13	**Miami: home**	arrive 7:00 AM	—	Don't book an early-morning flight.

Documents: for this round trip NCL accepts a passport, or a state-certified US birth certificate with a government photo ID. NCL "strongly recommends" a passport.

Service charge: $20 per person per day in standard cabins, $25 in suites and The Haven (NCL, October 2026). That's $240 for twelve nights in a standard cabin. Ask Tina whether your group rate includes it.

Weather, in one line: five years of records for these dates average highs of 80°F in Miami to 91°F in Cartagena, with rain on most days at Puerto Limón and about half at the canal. Not a forecast. Bring a rain jacket for Days 9 and 10.

The ship's future. NCL's parent company said in April 2025 that Norwegian Sun will be chartered to Cordelia Cruises, starting in 2027. Your March sailing was on sale in October 2026; NCL and Tina will tell you if anything changes.

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Getting to the ship and getting home

Sunday arrival, Monday boarding

Sunday, February 28: fly in. A day early means a late flight doesn't cost you the cruise.

Monday, March 1: boarding.

- **Terminal:** PortMiami lists Terminal B, "The Pearl of Miami," as NCL's terminal, and Terminal C as shared. Your eDocs name yours.
- **Parking:** Garage B, 1756 N. Cruise Blvd., $35 a day; Garage C, $28 (PortMiami, effective January 1, 2025). No debit cards.
- **Arrival:** if you've checked in online, arrive no later than one hour before the boarding time you chose. Be aboard by 3:00 PM.
- **Carry-on:** passport, medications, swimsuit, change of clothes, charger.
- **Sailaway with the group:** Tina will say where to meet.

Saturday, March 13: home

- The ship is due in at 7:00 AM.
- Keep your passport, medications and a change of clothes with you.

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Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship

- **Included restaurants:** Four Seasons and Seven Seas (Deck 5), the Garden Café buffet and The Great Outdoors (Deck 11), and the Sports Bar (Deck 11, 24 hours).
- **Specialty restaurants:** Cagney's, Teppanyaki, Le Bistro, Los Lobos, the Sushi Bar, La Cucina and Moderno. $40 to $60 cover, plus 20%, beyond your Free at Sea meals.
- **Free at Sea** (bookings from November 5, 2025): open bar for 21 and over, **four specialty meals on a cruise of nine nights or more**, 150 Wi-Fi minutes, and a $50 excursion credit per port for the first guest. The open bar carries $28.50 a day in gratuities (NCL's pre-cruise price), $342 for twelve nights. Your group rate may differ; ask Tina.
- **More Wi-Fi:** $29.99 a day per cabin, or $39.99 for streaming.
- **Shows:** the Stardust Theater (Decks 6 and 7).
- **Solo cabins:** Solo Inside, Oceanview and Balcony. Sun has no Studio cabins or Studio Lounge; Tina's group fills that gap.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Great Stirrup Cay:** a beach and a lounger, free.
- **Cabo Rojo:** an NCL Shore Excursion to Bahía de las Águilas, or an easy day at the port.
- **Aruba:** downtown Oranjestad and a beach.
- **Curaçao:** Willemstad on foot, across the Queen Emma Bridge.
- **Cartagena:** the walled city, with the group or an excursion. Back by 1:00 PM.
- **The canal:** a spot on the open deck at 5:00 AM.
- **Colón:** a short walk near the terminal, or stay aboard.
- **Puerto Limón:** look for sloths in port. Back by 12:30 PM.

Sailing solo, with a host

Tina is on board with the group. Pick one plan a day, eat where it's easy, and send one message home each evening. Fill in the handoff card before you go: it's a separate one-page document, and the full pack has it too.

The full Voyage Pack covers everything here in more depth. Soli Deo Gloria.

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